CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · NCERT-TYPE UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 13–17: **Saving the Gharial, The Elephant and the Tragopan, That Little Square Box, Marshlands, The Three Caskets** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. NCERT-type: questions in the style of the textbook examples and exercises.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. 'Saving the Gharial' is written by: 1

(a) Sudha Murty **(b)** Sunita Narain **(c)** Ruskin Bond **(d)** Janaki Lenin

2. 'The Elephant and the Tragopan' is a poem by: 1

(a) Rabindranath Tagore **(b)** Vikram Seth
(c) Ruskin Bond **(d)** Harivansh Rai Bachchan

3. The narrator of the story is travelling from: 1

(a) America to England **(b)** India to Africa
(c) England to Australia **(d)** France to Japan

4. 'Marshlands' was written by: 1

(a) E. Pauline Johnson **(b)** Emily Dickinson
(c) William Blake **(d)** Sarojini Naidu

5. 'The Three Caskets' is based on a play by: 1

(a) William Shakespeare **(b)** Charles Dickens
(c) Oscar Wilde **(d)** Rabindranath Tagore

6. Whitaker observed a male gharial's underwater jaw-clap in the: 1

(a) Chambal River **(b)** Yamuna River
(c) Indus River **(d)** Brahmaputra River

7. What is being built that will destroy the bamboo? 1

(a) a railway **(b)** a bridge only **(c)** a factory **(d)** a reservoir

8. At what time do the men plan to 'set it off'? 1

(a) dawn **(b)** midnight
(c) ten o'clock sharp **(d)** noon

9. The wild goose is described as 'homing', which means it is: 1

(a) returning home **(b)** hunting fish **(c)** lost **(d)** migrating south

10. Morocco chooses the: 1

(a) gold casket **(b)** lead casket **(c)** ivory casket **(d)** silver casket

11. In Satkosia Gorge, how many of the seven released gharials survived? 1

(a) all seven **(b)** five **(c)** two **(d)** none

12. Which sentence about the trout is true? 1

(a) It warns the elephant. **(b)** It leads the animals out of the valley.
(c) It welcomes the reservoir at first. **(d)** It owns the bamboo.

13. The clicking sound actually comes from: 1

(a) a clock **(b)** the ship's engine
(c) the pigeons inside the box **(d)** a bomb

14. The poem ends with the marshes: 1

(a) dancing **(b)** flooding **(c)** sleeping **(d)** burning

15. Bassanio chooses the: 1

(a) silver casket **(b)** lead casket **(c)** wooden casket **(d)** gold casket

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Who is the author of 'Saving the Gharial'? Whose work does she describe? 2

17. Who wrote 'The Elephant and the Tragopan'? 2

18. Where is the narrator travelling and on which ship? 2

19. Who wrote 'Marshlands'? 2

20. What was the test set by Portia's father? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Describe how a male gharial attracts females and challenges rivals. 3

22. Describe the elephant as a speaker in the poem. 3

23. Describe the box as the narrator saw it. 3

24. Describe the opening picture of the marsh. 3

OR

Describe the test arranged by Portia's father. 3

25. What does the Satkosia Gorge experience teach us? 3

OR

How does the poet use irony in the trout's reaction? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Describe the courtship and territorial behaviour of the male gharial as given in the chapter. 5

OR

Describe the conversation among the animals and what it reveals about humans. 5

27. Narrate the story of the little square box in your own words. 5

OR

Write a couplet-wise summary of 'Marshlands'. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND